



Repot baby plants that form along the leaf edge

Make your own

For older children, the Mexican hat plant will be easy to propagate.

Tweens

Dexterity and mental development progress rapidly at this age, so introducing tweens to growing plants themselves from young plantlets or cuttings is a rewarding and educational pursuit. The fun polka dots of *Hypoestes phyllostachya* will pique their curiosity and the cuttings taken from it will root easily, giving the child a real sense of pride and independent achievement.

The teen crib

Architectural plants such as the spineless yucca (see pp.140–141) are perfect for impressing your friends.



Young teens

Encourage this age group to grow fascinating plants on their windowsill. They are both old enough to be amazed by them and mature enough to carefully tend and nurture them. Varieties such as the Venus flytrap, the sensitive plant, and the prayer plant all have big personalities, as they move of their own accord, making them super interesting and great for showing off to friends.

Older teens

As teenagers move from childhood to adulthood and wish to distance themselves from their younger ways, plants are a great way to add low-maintenance, high-impact character to their rooms. As the bedroom becomes the “crib,” cool architectural plants such as yuccas and palms add a bit of grown-up style, while striking plants such as the blue torch cactus make for excellent talking points. Likewise, chic orchids give real kudos.